

The amount of data you can safely transfer is normally mentioned on the spec-sheet. In addition to that, manufacturers provide drivers and additional tools to keep track of how much data has been written already. Samsung Magician is one such tool released by Samsung to help you monitor their disks, and in a similar vein Corsair has SSD Toolkit to perform the same task. Also, current gen SSDs have the feature to automatically optimise storage block allocation to maximize the life of the SSD.

Most SSDs are 2.5-inch in size but there's an entirely new form factor called M.2 which has a much smaller footprint. These are commonly used in laptops but desktop motherboards also have M.2 slots to support them. Another recent addition is NVMe, which is a protocol that does away with the existing 600 Mbps limit that SATA III has. So you now have NVMe SSDs with transfer speeds of over 3,000 Mbps. However, they carry a similarly monstrous price tag as well. So depending on form factor, you should ensure that either your motherboard has an M.2 slot for M.2 SSDs or your cabinet has a 2.5-inch drive bay should you go with the classic 2.5-inch SSD. 

Hybrid Disks

Part of a hybrid disk is an SSD while the rest is a normal HDD. Mapping is done internally by a controller chip. The first few GBs are mapped to the SSD while the later parts are mapped to the HDD. When you install the OS on the first partition of the disk, it gets installed on the SSD, thus allowing for a super-fast OS startup. They are a win-win when it comes to performance/price ratio.